1、

The following appeared in a letter from a firm providing investment advice for a client. "Most homes in the northeastern United States, where winters are typically cold, have traditionally used oil as their major fuel for heating. Last heating season that region experienced 90 days with below-normal temperatures, and climate forecasters predict that this weather pattern will continue for several more years. Furthermore, many new homes are being built in the region in response to recent population growth. Because of these trends, we predict an increased demand for heating oil and recommend investment in Consolidated Industries, one of whose major business operations is the retail sale of home heating oil."

Write a response in which you examine the stated and/or unstated assumptions of the argument. Be sure to explain how the argument depends on these assumptions and what the implications are for the argument if the assumptions prove unwarranted.

在冬季非常寒冷的美国东北部的房屋里,一直都使用传统的油料作为取暖的主要燃料。去年该地区经历了 90 天低于往年平均气温的天气,并且气象预测家们预测这种天气将会持续数年。另外,去年由于人口增长,本地建造了很多的房屋。按此趋势, 我们预测对于油料的需求将会增加,同时也建议对 CI 公司投资,因为该公司的主要业务之一就是家用采暖油料的零售。

1. 去年的温蒂低于平均气温，但是低多少，没有说，如果只是低一点点呢，很明显不会让 oil 的需求量明显增多。

2. 90 天的氡气看似很久，但是可能以前的天数更多，可能有 100 多天，那不是今年就是个暖冬。

3. 作者 assume 天气预报一定是 accurate 的，那么有可能天气预报可能不准。

4. 很多新的住宅建起来不见得这些新的住宅都会持续使用 oil 作为取暖的能源，也学随着科学的进步，人们越来越多的使用 environmental friendly 的新能源；还有作者认为这些新建的房子都会卖掉，有可能这些房子放价过高，地段不好，交通不便利等等而卖不出去，所以也不能预测 oil 的需求量会增多。

5. 是一个利润预测的错误，profit=earn-cost， 那么这里 earn 的也不一定多，还不能保证 cost，所以不能保证 profit 一定多。

* 这里的第 5 点可以注意，所有的涉及 profit 的题目都可以找这个逻辑点。

2、

The following appeared in a memo to the board of directors of Bargain Brand Cereals. "One year ago we introduced our first product, Bargain Brand breakfast cereal. Our very low prices quickly drew many customers away from the top-selling cereal companies. Although the companies producing the top brands have since tried to compete with us by lowering their prices and although several plan to introduce their own budget brands, not once have we needed to raise our prices to continue making a profit. Given our success in selling cereal, we recommend that Bargain Brand now expand its business and begin marketing other low-priced food products as quickly as possible."

Write a response in which you discuss what questions would need to be answered in order to decide whether the recommendation and the argument on which it is based are reasonable. Be sure to explain how the answers to these questions would help to evaluate the recommendation.

一年以前我们推出了第一种名为 Bargain Brand 的早餐麦片产品。我们低廉的价格迅速从一些销量最大的麦片厂商那里吸引了大量客户。尽管这些厂商曾经试图通过降低价格来与我们竞争,并且尽管有一些公司打算推出他们自己的廉价品牌,但我们不需要通过涨价来维持盈利。基于我们销售麦片的成功,我们建议 Bargain Brand 应该扩展业务,并且尽快推出其他的廉价食品。

1. 错误的因果，作者 assume 早餐麦片的成功是因为低廉的价格，很有可能是这个麦片的质量好，味道好，营养价值高等等。
2. 其他的公司没能超越我们的也不是因为价格的因素，很有可能是其他的原因。
3. one year 的错误，基本上所有时间上的点我们都可以调时间错误，过去不能代表现在，现在也不能代表将来，过去不能预测将来等等。
4. 麦片的成功不代表其他的产品也会成功。扩展业务还有考虑很多其他的东西，经济环境啊，税收啊，房价，水电，顾客消费能力等等。

3、

The following appeared as part of an article in a business magazine. "A recent study rating 300 male and female Mentian advertising executives according to the average number of hours they sleep per night showed an association between the amount of sleep the executives need and the success of their firms. Of the advertising firms studied, those whose executives reported needing no more than 6 hours of sleep per night had higher profit margins and faster growth. These results suggest that if a business wants to prosper, it should hire only people who need less than 6 hours of sleep per night."

Write a response in which you examine the stated and/or unstated assumptions of the argument. Be sure to explain how the argument depends on these assumptions and what the implications are for the argument if the assumptions prove unwarranted.

最近一项研究包括了 300 名 M 广告公司男女高管的每天平均睡眠时间的调查显示,高管们所需的睡眠时间与他们公司成功与否之间存在着关联。根据对这些广告公司的研究,那些高管报告说每天睡眠不超过 6 小时的公司,公司利润更高并且发展更快。这些结果表 明如果公司想蓬勃发展,他们必须只雇佣那些每天睡眠不足 6 小时的人员。

1. 错误的归因，睡眠不足 6 小时不是公司发展好的原因，而是一个 confounder。
2. 样本量 300，可以挑错。
3. 作者 assume 要想 business 发展的好，就只能靠雇佣睡眠不足 6 小时的人，当然还有更多其他的方法来发展公司的 business。
4. 只雇佣睡眠不足 6 个小时的员工实际不可行，怎么保证雇佣的人是只睡不到 6 小时的人。

4、
In an attempt to improve highway safety, Prunty County last year lowered its speed limit from 55 to 45 miles per hour on all county highways. But this effort has failed: the number of accidents has not decreased, and, based on reports by the highway patrol, many drivers are exceeding the speed limit. Prunty County should instead undertake the same kind of road improvement project that Butler County completed five years ago: increasing lane widths, resurfacing rough highways, and improving visibility at dangerous intersections. Today, major Butler County roads still have a 55 mph speed limit, yet there were 25 percent fewer reported accidents in Butler County this past year than there were five years ago.

Write a response in which you discuss what specific evidence is needed to evaluate the argument and explain how the evidence would weaken or strengthen the argument.

为了提升高速公路的安全性, Prunty 去年把所有高速公路的限制速度由 55mph 降到了 45mph。但是这样的尝试失败了:事故发生的数量没有下降,并且高速公路巡警的报告显示很多司机都超速驾驶。所以 Prunty 同样应该采用 Butler 5 年前所执行的道路改善计划:增加车道宽度,重新铺设不平路面以及改善危险交叉路口的能见度。今天,Butler 的主要道路的限制速度依然是 55mph,但上报的事故率却比 5 年前减少了 25%。

1. 数据错误 25%，在不知道基数的情况下，无法判断 25%的下降是不是有效，是不是明显。
2. P 市措施没有取得预期的效果，但是不代表措施没有效果，可能是其他的原因导致了 accidents。
3. B 市的成功不代表是实施措施的效果，可能措施只是一个 confounder，而真正起效果的是其他的因素。即使 B 市成功了，但是也是 5 年前的背景环境，随着时间的变化，5 年过去了，不代表这个措施还会有效。
4. 比较错误，P 市和 B 市不完全相同，不存在可比性，不代表 B 市有效 P 市就会有效。

5、

The following appeared in a memo from a vice president of a large, highly diversified company. "Ten years ago our company had two new office buildings constructed as regional headquarters for two regions. The buildings were erected by different construction companies—Alpha and Zeta. Although the two buildings had identical floor plans, the building constructed by Zeta cost 30 percent more to build. However, that building's expenses for maintenance last year were only half those of Alpha's. In addition, the energy consumption of the Zeta building has been lower than that of the Alpha building every year since its construction. Given these data, plus the fact that Zeta has a stable workforce with little employee turnover, we recommend using Zeta rather than Alpha for our new building project, even though Alpha's bid promises lower construction costs."

Write a response in which you discuss what questions would need to be answered in order to decide whether the recommendation and the argument on which it is based are reasonable. Be sure to explain how the answers to these questions would help to evaluate the recommendation.

10 年以前,我们公司在两个不同地区拥有两座办公建筑作为地区总部。它们由两家建筑公：Alpha 和 Zeta。尽管两座建筑的平面布局基本相同,由 Zeta 所建造的建筑造价高出了 30%,但去年的维护费用是由 Alpha 所建的楼的 50%。而且,Z 大楼建成以来,每年的能耗都比 Alpha 大楼要少。这些数据,再加上 Z 公司拥有稳定的员工队伍且其雇员流动性很小的事实,表明我们应该使用 Z 建筑公司而不是 A 公司 来建造未来的建筑工程,尽管 A 的标书承诺造价会更低。

1. 数据错误， 30%，50%，没有基数的情况下，无法判断 30%是多是少。
2. 时间错误，去年的费用不能代表过去，也不能说明将来。
3. 地区不同，可能有地区差异，可能 Z 公司所在地区比 A 市所在地区更有优势。
4. Z 公司有稳定的员工，流动性小不代表他们工作效率就高。可能 A 公司比较大，人员相对流动比较大也是 可以理解的。
5. Z 每年的能耗都比 A 少，但是没有具体说少多少，如果只少一点点也没有意义；还

有楼的用途不一样，地理位置不同都有可能造成他们能耗的不同。

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6、

The vice president of human resources at Climpson Industries sent the following recommendation to the company's president. "In an effort to improve our employees' productivity, we should implement electronic monitoring of employees' Internet use from their workstations. Employees who use the Internet from their workstations need to be identified and punished if we are to reduce the number of work hours spent on personal or recreational activities, such as shopping or playing games. By installing software to detect employees' Internet use on company computers, we can prevent employees from wasting time, foster a better work ethic at Climpson, and improve our overall profits."

Write a response in which you examine the stated and/or unstated assumptions of the argument. Be sure to explain how the argument depends on these assumptions and what the implications are for the argument if the assumptions prove unwarranted.

为提高我们的员工的生产效率,我们应该在员工的电脑上安装电子监控来监视员工的上网情况。如果我们要减少员工用于私人以及娱乐活动的时间,比如工作时间购物或玩游戏,那些在电脑上不正当使用互联网的员工必须要被识别出来并且受到惩罚。通过在公司电脑上安装检测员工使用互联网的软件,我们可以防止员工浪费时间,并培养公司更好的工作氛围,以及提高我们公司的整体利润。

1. 条件类错误，作者认为安装电子监控来监视员工就能减少员工浪费时间，员工可能会找监控死点继续上网，或者使用手机，那样电脑就识别不出来。
2. 作者认为安装监控可以培养更好的工作氛围，可能会导致员工不满，消极罢工。
3. 安装监控不一定能提高效率，即使员工不上网他们也不一定会放心思在工作上。
4. 利润错误，安装监控不一定能提高工作效率，即使提高了工作效率也不能保证利润提高，利润还收收入及支出的影响，还有经济的大环境等等。

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7、
The following appeared in a health newsletter. "A ten-year nationwide study of the effectiveness of wearing a helmet while bicycling indicates that ten years ago, approximately 35 percent of all bicyclists reported wearing helmets, whereas today that number is nearly 80 percent. Another study, however, suggests that during the same ten-year period, the number of bicycle-related accidents has increased 200 percent. These results demonstrate that bicyclists feel safer because they are wearing helmets, and they take more risks as a result. Thus, to reduce the number of serious injuries from bicycle accidents, the government should concentrate more on educating people about bicycle safety and less on encouraging or requiring bicyclists to wear helmets."

Write a response in which you examine the stated and/or unstated assumptions of the argument. Be sure to explain how the argument depends on these assumptions and what the implications are for the argument if the assumptions prove unwarranted.
一项为期十年的对于在骑自行车时戴头盔的作用的研究显示,10 年前,所有骑 车人中大约有 35%报告说他们戴头盔,现在这个比例接近 80%。然而另外一项 调查显示在相同的十年期间,因骑车引起的事故数量增加了 200%。这些结果说 明骑车人因为戴着头盔而感到更安全,因而导致他们面临更大的危险。因此,为 减少自行车事故中严重伤害的数量,政府应该更多地对人们加强自行车安全的教 育,并提供鼓励或要求骑车人戴头盔的课程。
1. accidents incident rate 升高，不代表这个问题比以前严重，有可能市人口增加，骑车的人数增多，所以是事故的发生率增多；还有可能是现在机动车多了，有他们的不安全驾驶导致的事故率上升等等。
2. 即使事故发生率增多了，但是我们并不知道发生事故的人的具体的戴安全帽的情况，可能出事故的就是没有戴安全帽的人。
3. 错误的因果关系，人们不是因为戴了安全帽而冒险，可能那些人就是爱冒险的人
4. 安全教育也不是唯一能够降低事故率的方法，还有其他方法可以降低事故发生率，比如限速，改善交通，安装修理路灯等等。

8、

The following is a recommendation from the personnel director to the president of Acme Publishing Company. "Many other companies have recently stated that having their employees take the Easy Read Speed-Reading Course has greatly improved productivity. One graduate of the course was able to read a 500-page report in only two hours; another graduate rose from an assistant manager to vice president of the company in under a year. Obviously, the faster you can read, the more information you can absorb in a single workday. Moreover, Easy Read would cost Acme only $500 per employee—a small price to pay when you consider the benefits. Included in this fee is a three-week seminar in Spruce City and a lifelong subscription to the Easy Read newsletter. Clearly, to improve productivity, Acme should require all of our employees to take the Easy Read course."

Write a response in which you discuss what questions would need to be answered in order to decide whether the advice and the argument on which it is based are reasonable. Be sure to explain how the answers to these questions would help to evaluate the advice.

很多其他公司最近指出他们的员工参加了 Easy Read 的速读课程之后生产效率显 著提高。这个课程的一名毕业生能够在两个小时之内读完长达 500 页的报告,另一名毕业生在一年内从助理经理上升到了副总裁。显然,你的阅读速度越快,在 一天之内所能吸收的信息就越多。而且,Easy Read 的学费只有每人 500 元,当 考虑到它给 A 公司带来的效益的时候这就是个小数目。这个费用包括在 S 市举行的为期三周的研讨会和 Easy Read 新闻刊物的终生赠阅。显然,为了提高 A 公司 的整体生产效率,它要求所有员工参加 Easy Read 的课程。

1. 样本数量问题太大，只有 2 个样本，不够科学。
2. 员工可以读 2 小时读 500 页不代表他们读的快，可能他们参加 easy read 之前读的就快，和课程无关。
3. 员工参加完 easy read 课程后升值到副总裁，不代表就是课程的原因，可能员工本来就很努力，资质很高，工作能力很强等等。
4. 每人 500，话费不多。我们不知道公司有多少员工，如果员工数量特别庞大那么总数就很多了；还有课程 500，但是还有其他的费用，课本费啊，交通费啊，误工费啊等等。

5. 所有员工都参加也不合理，可能公司的性质不同，工作的岗位不同，举例，保洁部门，hr 等等的工作岗位不用速读技能，所以让所有员工都参加速读培训也是一种浪费。

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9、

The following appeared in a letter from a homeowner to a friend.

"Of the two leading real estate firms in our town—Adams Realty and Fitch Realty—Adams Realty is clearly superior. Adams has 40 real estate agents; in contrast, Fitch has 25, many of whom work only part-time. Moreover, Adams' revenue last year was twice as high as that of Fitch and included home sales that averaged $168,000, compared to Fitch's $144,000. Homes listed with Adams sell faster as well: ten years ago I listed my home with Fitch, and it took more than four months to sell; last year, when I sold another home, I listed it with Adams, and it took only one month. Thus, if you want to sell your home quickly and at a good price, you should use Adams Realty."

OBJ

Write a response in which you examine the stated and/or unstated assumptions of the argument. Be sure to explain how the argument depends on these assumptions and what the implications are for the argument if the assumptions prove unwarranted.

本市的两家最大的房地产经纪公司--Adams Realty 和 Fitch Realty--之中,Adams 显然更优秀一些。Adams 有 40 名房地产经纪人,而 Fitch 只有 25 个,且很多是 兼职工作。而且,Adams 去年的收入是 Fitch 的两倍,其平均房价为$168000,而 Fitch 仅为$144000。在 Adams 销售的房屋卖得也更快:十年前,我把我的房产交 给 Fitch,它用了四个多月才卖出去;去年,我在 Adams 卖了另一处房产,仅用 一个月就售出了。因此,要想让你的房产卖的更快更好,你应该选择 Adams。

1. 时间错误：去年 A 公司的收入高，不代表过去和以后都高。

2. 数字错误：2 倍不一定多，如果基数很小，那么两倍也见得会高很多；平均房价高不代表每个房子价格都高，可能是由于个别的房子提高了 A 的平均值，F 公司大部分都都卖的很高，而被个别的房子降低了平均值。

3. 员工多不代表优秀。

4. 两个公司卖房子的事件不具有可比性，还有房地产的大环境，所卖房子的具体情况。

10、

The following appeared in a letter to the school board in the town of Centerville.

"All students should be required to take the driver's education course at Centerville High School. In the past two years, several accidents in and around Centerville have involved teenage drivers. Since a number of parents in Centerville have complained that they are too busy to teach their teenagers to drive, some other instruction is necessary to ensure that these teenagers are safe drivers. Although there are two driving schools in Centerville, parents on a tight budget cannot afford to pay for driving instruction. Therefore an effective and mandatory program sponsored by the high school is the only solution to this serious problem."

Write a response in which you examine the stated and/or unstated assumptions of the argument. Be sure to explain how the argument depends on these assumptions and what the implications are for the argument if the assumptions prove unwarranted.

Centerville 高中的所有学生都应该被要求参加驾驶员教育课程。在过去两年中，Centerville 周围有几起交通事故涉及了青少年驾驶员。由于 Centerville 的一些家长抱怨说他们太忙没有时间教他们的孩子驾驶,因此必须有一些其他的课程来保证孩子安全驾驶。尽管在 Centerville 已经有两所驾校,但预算不足的家长 无法负担驾校学费。因此解决这一问题的唯一方法是由学校组织的有效且具有强制性的课程。

1. 错误归因，这些交通事故可能并不是有青少年驾驶者导致的，造成事故该负责人的一方是其他的驾驶员。还有可能不是人为因素导致的交通事故，可能道路的安全设施不好，天气恶劣等等。

2. 学校组织的课程也不一定有效，而且强制性的课程可能造成更多的不满，引起更多的问题

3. 解决问题的唯一办法不一定是学校组织的课程，还有其他的方法可以解决，比如其他的社团自助，政府开展社区课程等等。

4. 时间错误，过去两年不能代表现在和将来的情况。